far below the national average of 60 per cent. The only group with a lower rate of labor force participation is Arab women. And army enlistment represents roughly 20 per cent of the possible conscripts each year.

It's impossible to say what fraction of the *haredi* community supports the status quo. Indeed, this is arguably the community's biggest problem. Rabbis and politicians set the agenda; everyone else is expected to fall in line. Those who don't are often subjected to harassment. Children in ultra-Orthodox neighborhoods routinely spit on uniformed soldiers, or throw stones at them. A young conscript once explained to me how he stops in a secular part of Jerusalem whenever he goes home for leave. He ducks into a hotel or cafe, doffs his uniform in the bathroom, and puts on traditional garb. "I'd like to encourage other guys to enlist," he said. "But you can't in our community, because the extremists will come after you."

A poster campaign in ultra-Orthodox neighborhoods a few years ago called conscripts *hardakim*, a portmanteau of *haredi* and *herek*, the Hebrew word for "insect". Another one portrayed them as pigs. A few months after the 2015 election, activists started circulating a pamphlet entitled "Soul Hunters", which published the personal details—names, photos, even home addresses—of *haredi* men who work as army recruiters. It called them "professional missionaries" who "sold their souls to the devil for financial gain."

More troubling for Israel's future is the issue of education. Thousands of *haredi* students graduate each year without learning basic math, science, and English. A law passed under Netanyahu's third government offered a small fix: it required schools to teach at least ten hours of secular studies each week; those that refused would lose one-third of their state funding. But the law was quickly canceled once the ultra-Orthodox parties returned to power. Some *haredi* men would like to work—but they finish school totally unprepared to find a job. "That's why I enlisted," said another soldier, who hoped to work in the high-tech sector after his service. "I'm not going to learn computer programming in Bnei Brak." (Dozens of ultra-Orthodox men have sued the state, claiming they were "abandoned" and left to graduate without a secular education.)

It isn't just the ultra-Orthodox parties who are complicit. A recent study of developed countries found that Israeli students had fallen from seventh place to sixteenth in maths, and from thirteenth to nineteenth in science. Naftali Bennett called the findings a "national emergency", which is not an